

FREE GUIDE · FROM THE FAMILY AT SHOPEASE FOODS ·
SINCE 1984

The Family Freezer Plan

How Ontario families buy their food for the year, keep the grocery bill under control, and always have dinner in the house. No fluff, no sales pitch. Just what we have learned filling family freezers for forty years.

When it comes to food, we deliver.

1. Why families are switching to freezer plans

You have seen your grocery bill. It goes up, it never comes down, and the cart seems to hold less every year. Buying your family's core food in bulk, once or twice a year, fixes three problems at once:

- **You stop paying this week's price.** When you buy in bulk direct, the price is set once. Grocery stores reprice every week and you absorb it.
- **Dinner stops being a 5pm decision.** A stocked freezer means the answer to "what's for dinner" is already in the house.
- **You waste less.** Properly portioned and vacuum-sealed food gets eaten. The wilting produce drawer and the mystery leftovers mostly disappear.

It is not for everyone. If your family eats out five nights a week, a freezer plan will not fix that. But if you cook most nights and you are tired of the bill, this is worth an hour of your attention.

2. How much freezer do you actually need

Freezer	What it holds	Right for
Fridge-top freezer only	A few weeks of overflow	Starting point. Most families outgrow it fast.

Small chest (7 to 10 cu ft)	A serious food order for a smaller household	Couples, families of 2 to 3
Mid chest (10 to 15 cu ft)	A full family order with room to spare	Families of 3 to 5. The sweet spot.
Large chest or upright (15+ cu ft)	Big family orders, split-nothing households	Families of 5+ , hunters, big batch cooks

Tip: a chest freezer costs pennies a day to run, and a full freezer runs cheaper than an empty one. If space is tight, split deliveries solve it: half your order now, half later in the year. That is how a lot of our families do it.

3. Build your plan, category by category

Walk your last month of dinners and check off what your family actually eats. This list mirrors how we build real food plans with our customers.

Beef

☐	Ground beef in 1 lb packs. The workhorse. Count how many nights a week it shows up: tacos, spaghetti, burgers, chili.
☐	Steaks: ribeye, New York strip, sirloin, T-bone. Be honest about steak nights and celebrate them.
☐	Roasts: prime rib, sirloin tip, blade. One Sunday roast can feed the family twice.

Pork

☐	Centre-cut chops, tenderloin, loin roasts
☐	Bacon and peameal. Breakfast counts as food planning too.
☐	Back ribs, hams, dinner sausage

Poultry

☐	Boneless skinless chicken breasts. Most families under-guess how many they go through.
☐	Thighs, drumsticks, wings, whole birds
☐	A turkey for the holidays, bought before holiday pricing

Fish, variety and sides

☐	Salmon, haddock, trout, shrimp
☐	Family-night food: chicken strips, lasagne, stuffed chicken, a dessert worth hiding
☐	Frozen vegetables: the vitamins are locked in at harvest, and nothing rots in the crisper
☐	Pantry staples your family already buys: soups, pasta, sauces, cereals

4. The budget math, honestly

Do this on paper before you talk to anyone, including us.

1. What do you spend on groceries in a normal week? \$ _____
2. Roughly what share of that is meat, frozen food and pantry staples, versus fresh items like milk, bread and produce? Most families land near half. \$ _____
3. That number is what a freezer plan should replace. Not your whole bill, and anyone who promises to replace your whole grocery bill is selling you something.

The test that matters: a good plan fits inside the number you already spend, locks that price for a fixed term in writing, and leaves your weekly fresh run for the store. If the math does not work on your own numbers, walk away. That goes for us too.

5. Ten dinners that come straight out of the freezer

1. Sunday prime rib roast with frozen vegetables	6. Haddock with fries, Friday night classic
2. Weeknight tacos from 1 lb ground beef packs	7. Meat lasagne and a bagged salad
3. Chicken breasts, marinated the morning of	8. Honey garlic sausage with peppers and rice
4. Back ribs, slow cooked while you work	9. Salmon fillets with corn and peas
5. Steak night. You earned it once a week.	10. Chicken strips and fries for the kids, real ones

6. Questions to ask any bulk food company

Ask these of anyone who wants to fill your freezer, including us. The answers separate the pros from the pitch.

- **Do I approve every single item before anything is ordered?** If they push preset boxes, your freezer fills with food nobody eats.
- **Is the quality guarantee in writing, and for how long?** A handshake guarantee is not one.
- **Is my price locked for a fixed term, in writing?**
- **Who delivers it?** Their own people, or a courier who leaves boxes in the sun?
- **Can they cut and package meat to my instructions?** Thickness, pack sizes, the way your family actually cooks.
- **Will they build to my budget, or to their package?** The plan should start with your number.

See your own family's plan

Our 2-minute survey asks how your family eats and builds your starting plan before anyone calls you. Then a real Food Planner fine-tunes it with you, priced to your budget, no obligation.

shopeasefoods.com/survey.html

Or call us: (800) 361-3418 toll-free · (705) 745-4242 in Peterborough · Text (705) 304-0080
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